



enTourage eDGe dual book

notepad, and audio/video recorder and player in one. The two-screen device opens like a book with facing pages. The two screens of the enTourage eDGe—e-reader screen and colour touch screen—interact in many ways.

The 24.6cm (measured diagonally) screen makes reading e-books much easier than on smaller screens, reducing the number of page turns. It includes the advantages of other e-readers, with zooming capability, a glare-free screen and the ability to read in sunlight.

The device uses e-Ink technology, which lets you take notes right on the book you are reading.

You can move files onto your enTourage eDGe using an SD card or a USB flash drive. The mini-USB port can be used to move files back and forth from a Windows, MAC or Linux-based PC.

The enTourage eDGe colour touch-screen is a complete notebook, ready to play movies or MP3s, organise your books, notes and pictures, and even allows users to send instant message to their friends. The screen measures 25.6 cm diagonally.

The notebook functionality comes with Web browsing, audio/video record and playback, an e-mail function and other features like contacts list, calculator, alarm clock and library function to manage your books and files. The enTourage eDGe uses the Google Android operating system, so you can add other applications you need.

It has built-in WiFi and future support for 3G using an EVDO or HSDPA mobile modem. It also includes Blue-

tooth capability to add an external keyboard.

The enTourage eDGe can easily carry thousands of books with the built-in 3GB of usable memory.

eDGe has been designed to let you go all day without recharging the battery. The lithium ion battery can last up to 16 hours of reading without recharging. The device will start shipping

in February 2010.

Smartphones can help diagnose acute appendicitis

By using a handheld device or mobile phone equipped with special software, radiologists can now accurately diagnose acute appendicitis from a remote location.

Appendicitis, or inflammation and infection of the appendix, is a medical emergency requiring surgical removal of the organ. Transmitting the images over a mobile device will allow instant consultation and diagnosis from a remote location. It will also aid in surgical planning.

Typically, a patient arriving at the emergency room with suspected appendicitis undergoes computed tomography (CT) and a physical examination. If a radiologist is not immediately available to interpret the CT images, or in situations when consultation with a specialist is required but the diagnosis is delayed, the risk of rupture increases.

The new technology can expedite diagnosis and therefore treatment of appendicitis. In the long run, this technique presents great potential for improving emergency room care, as evidenced by decreased rates of ruptured appendicitis, shorter hospital stays and fewer complications.

Virtual nurses for HIV patients

Canada's Montreal University has created virtual peers or nurses that

HIV patients can reach out to, as they struggle to adhere to their antiretroviral programmes. Isabelle, Martin, Marc and Geneviève are some of the virtual peers created to help people living with HIV to optimise their treatment, as part of a new virtual clinic that is under study at the hospital of the University of Montreal.

The user-friendly Web programme is entitled VIH-TAVIE, which stands for nurse-assisted, HIV treatment and teaching for life. VIH-TAVIE provides support on how to best integrate treatment into one's lifestyle—at a restaurant or while travelling, for instance—and dealing with the significant side-effects of HIV drugs.

The programme also provides support to patients who are confronted with life-changing trials and tribulations, not to mention questioning and anxiety that may result from therapy. Since they began testing the programme, study participants stated that they had gained an upper hand on their condition.

The original nature of VIH-TAVIE is how the programme interacts with users and differs from comparable Web applications where interaction is minimal. Both the virtual and the real nurse and study coordinator (who are one in the same), Geneviève Rouleau, provide feedback and positive reinforcement to patients during online sessions. The virtual assistant, as personified by the nurse, engages patients in the development of self-management skills for their antiretroviral therapy.

World's costliest phone

British designer Stuart Hughes has created the world's most expensive mobile phone—the iPhone 3G Supreme. Priced at Rs 147 million, the phone is made from 22-carat gold. Hughes took 10 months to design the phone for the Liverpool-based Goldstriker International.

He blessed the phone with the finest precious metal and jewels. It comes with a 7 kg chest, which is made from a single block of granite, offset with Kashmir gold and with Nubuck top grain leather inner lining.